

created by the US in the last two centuries which has been a triumph of immigrant enterprise.

Looking towards the century ahead, enterprise and technology—now comfortably nestled in an enabling environment in India—promise yet another frontier for India to conquer: climate change.

Although it ended with mixed results, the recently concluded COP27 made clear that technology will be critical to climate mitigation and adaptation. As such, accelerating technological innovation should be prioritised. India, with its deep and tested pool of engineering talent, is a fit partner for global capital inves-

tors looking for quick-to-market ideas and solutions. Of course, India is itself a significant emitter of greenhouse gases, but that should serve to hasten its innovation of climate technologies.

In my view, India's engineers are qualified to do for climate technology what their predecessors did two decades ago for back-office business operations the world over. That somewhat accidental revolution changed business processes and raised the bar on business efficiency—and India's brand emerged. I believe the combination of exceptional engineering and consumer-service sensitivities, along with headline-

leading concerns such as climate, could be an opportunity for India to deliver on climate technology.

But technology alone is not sufficient. Nature-based solutions are often overlooked or relegated to the margins of India's climate strategies. That's why we have been holistic in our approach. We've studied the causes of coastal erosion in Andhra Pradesh; we designed and implemented community-level afforestation efforts in northern India; and we've created a multilingual mobile app using satellite imagery and machine learning to help farmers in Haryana reduce noxious stubble burning in towns and cities in the northern hinterland.

Whether action is driven by new technologies, proven ideas, or the confluence of the two, it should happen quickly. According to the UN Intergovernmental Panel on Climate Change, India is currently among the "most vulnerable" to the impact of global warming. Wildfires, droughts, floods, and extreme weather events have devastated communities across India this year. And, as I touched on earlier, India is the world's third-largest carbon emitter and second-largest coal user. Every fifth person in the world lives in India and, as they grow, so too will their consumption of fuels and materials. The challenge is grave... and urgent.

That said, a future upended by climate change that compromises growth is not pre-ordained. For the private sector in India, this is the moment to step up and engage policymakers and civil society in developing much-needed solutions. The road to 100 won't be easy. But it represents a critical opportunity for India to build a stronger nation and healthier planet for generations to come. **BT**

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